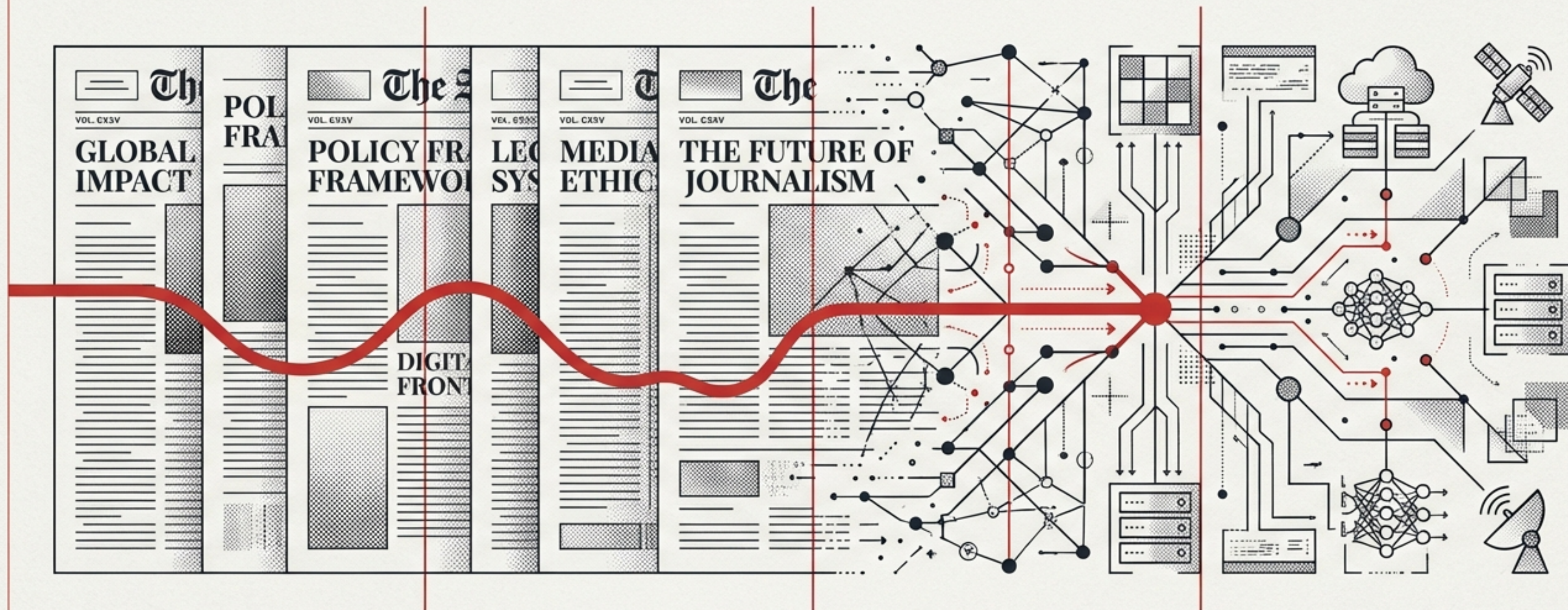


The SPUR Coalition

Shaping the rules, standards, and infrastructure for the AI age.



A MANIFESTO FOR GLOBAL MEDIA LEADERS

A pivotal moment for the media industry

Artificial Intelligence is fundamentally reshaping how content is created, distributed, discovered, and monetised.

Digital Media Era

The Inflection Point

The AI Era

We are at an **inflection point**. The industry must act to **protect original journalism** and secure **long-term sustainability**.

AI brings opportunities... but also raises urgent questions about fairness, consent, attribution, transparency, and trust.

The erosion of trust and value



Unauthorised Usage

Reporting, archives, and original content are being scraped and reused without permission.

Economic Threat

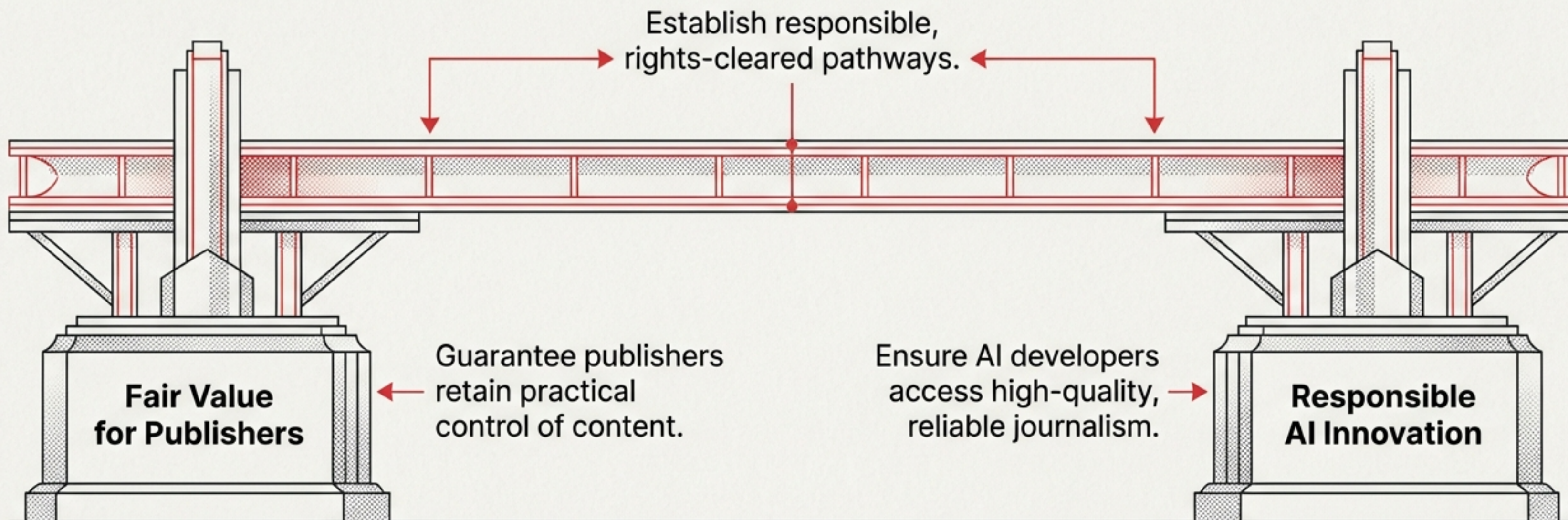
The lack of common standards weakens the economic model that supports journalism.

Public Trust

A lack of transparency regarding how AI answers are created risks eroding trust in both news and technology.

A vision for a symbiotic future

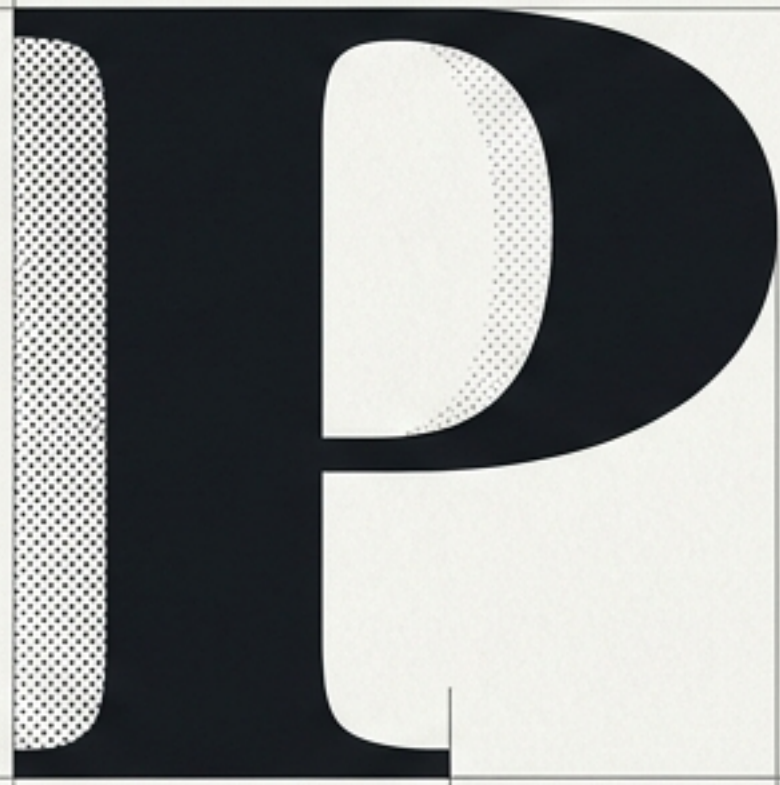
Shaping a market that rewards original reporting and supports responsible AI innovation.



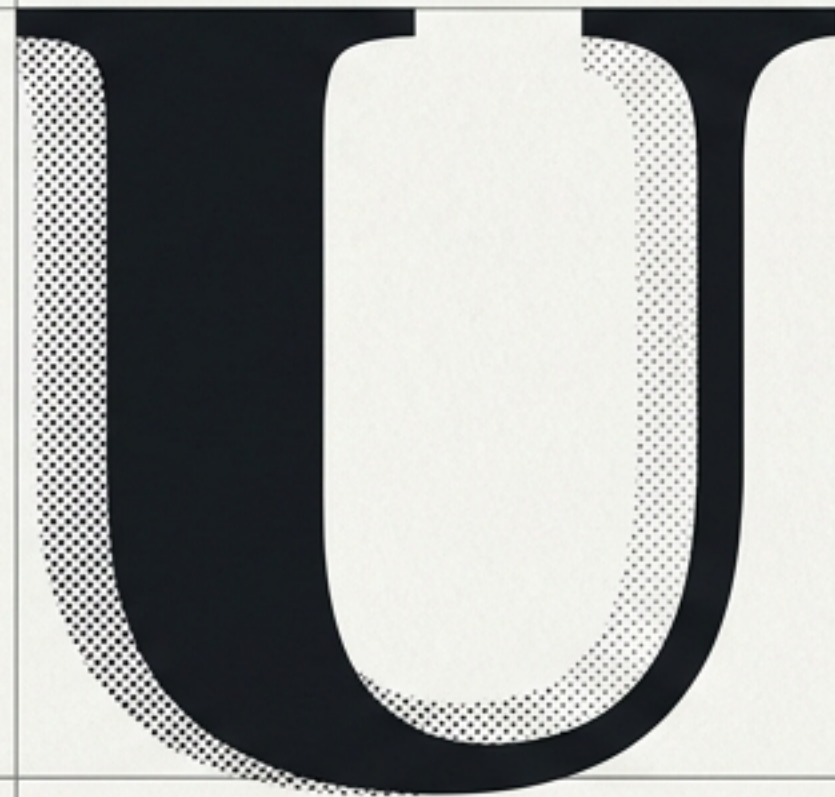
Introducing SPUR



Standards



Publisher



Usage



Rights

BBC

FT FINANCIAL
TIMES

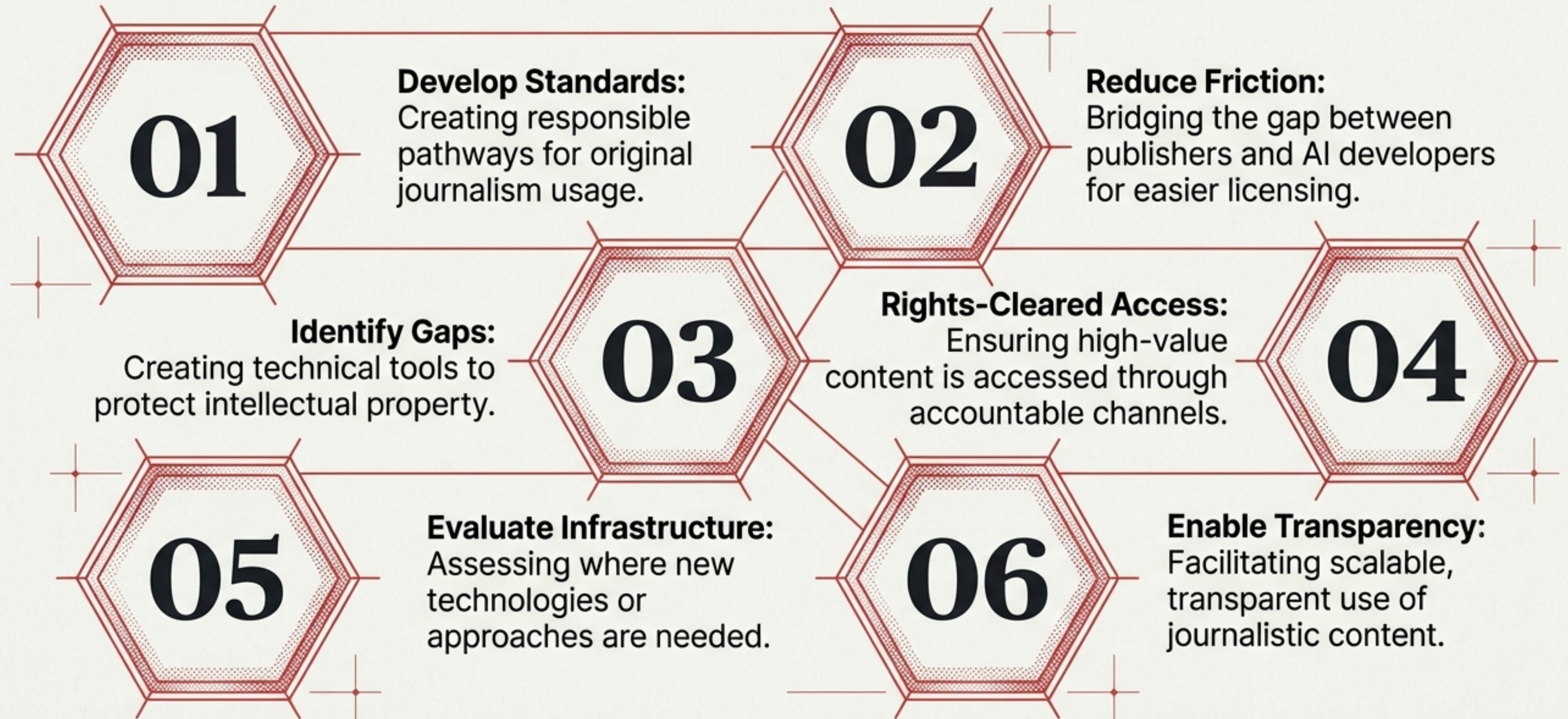
**The
Guardian**

sky NEWS

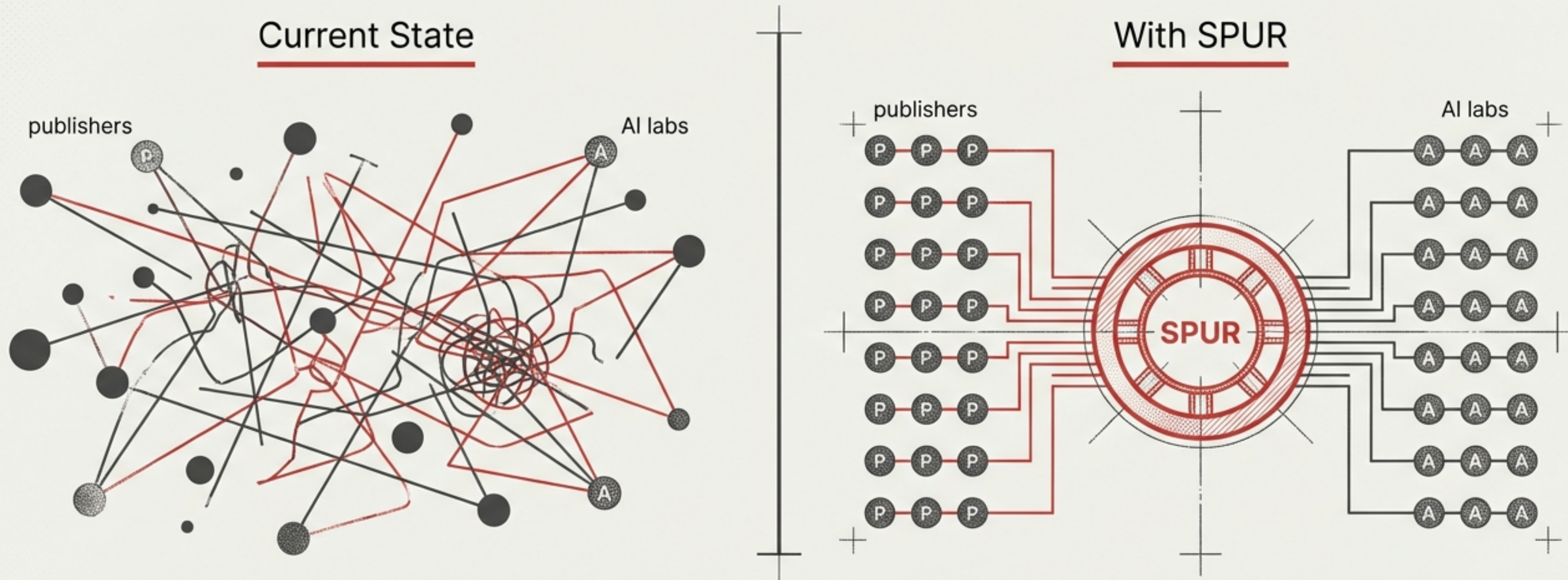
**Telegraph
Media Group**

Mission: To establish shared technical standards and responsible licensing frameworks.

The six core objectives

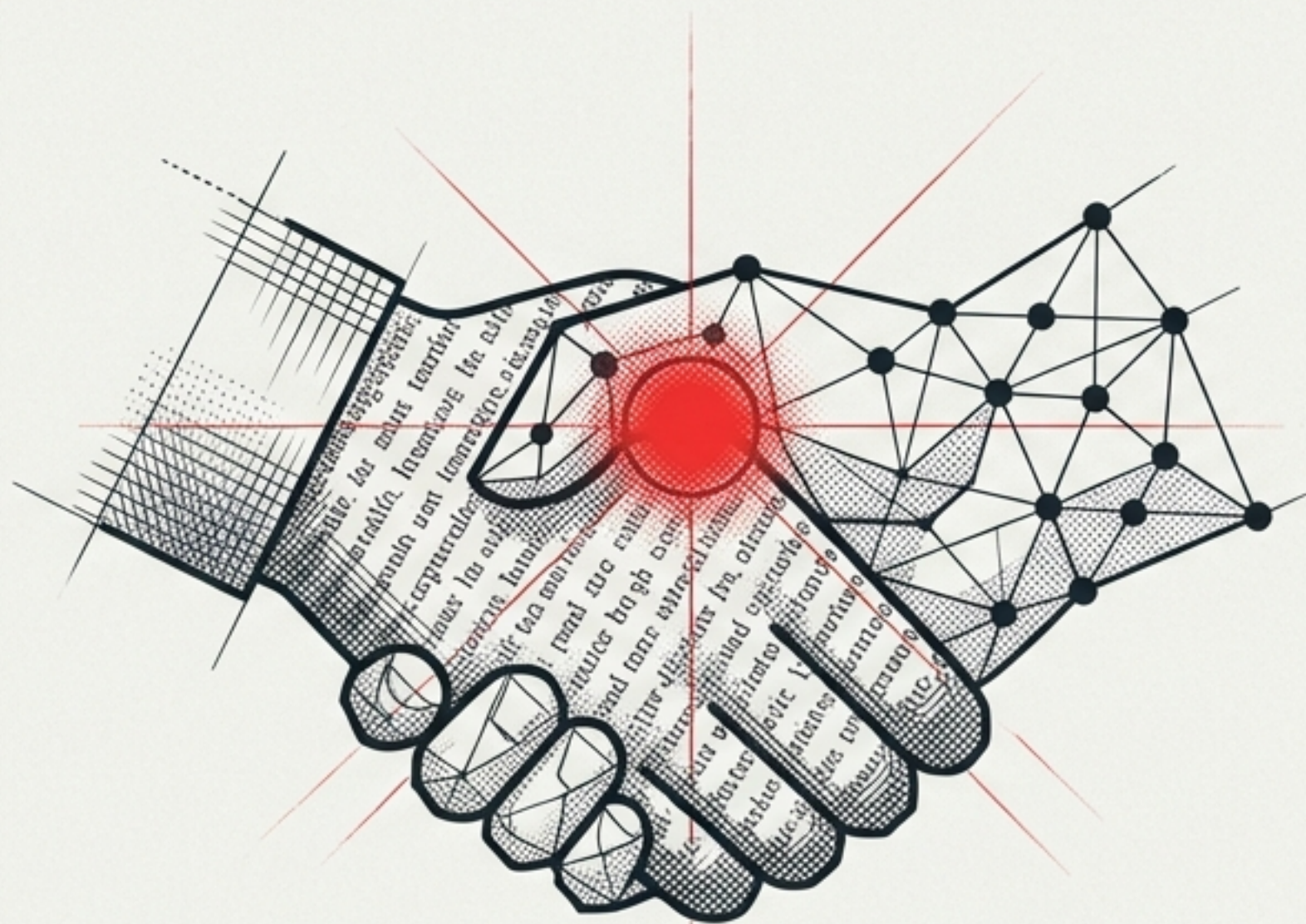


Why standards require a coalition



Individual negotiation is inefficient for the standards layer. SPUR shapes the technical and commercial environment so IP owners can control and monitor usage.

Creating value for AI developers



SPUR engages extensively with the buy-side to ensure solutions create value for licensees.

We provide legitimate, convenient access to high-quality data (journalism) to ground generative models.

We invite any developers who may wish to engage with the coalition to contact us directly.

Collective standards, individual autonomy



SPUR is NOT a collective licensing organisation.

Focus is on developing recommended standards and defining best practice.

Founders and members retain full autonomy over their own commercial relationships.

A global challenge requires a global solution



Geographic Scope

Issues are global; solutions must work for businesses worldwide. Not UK-only.

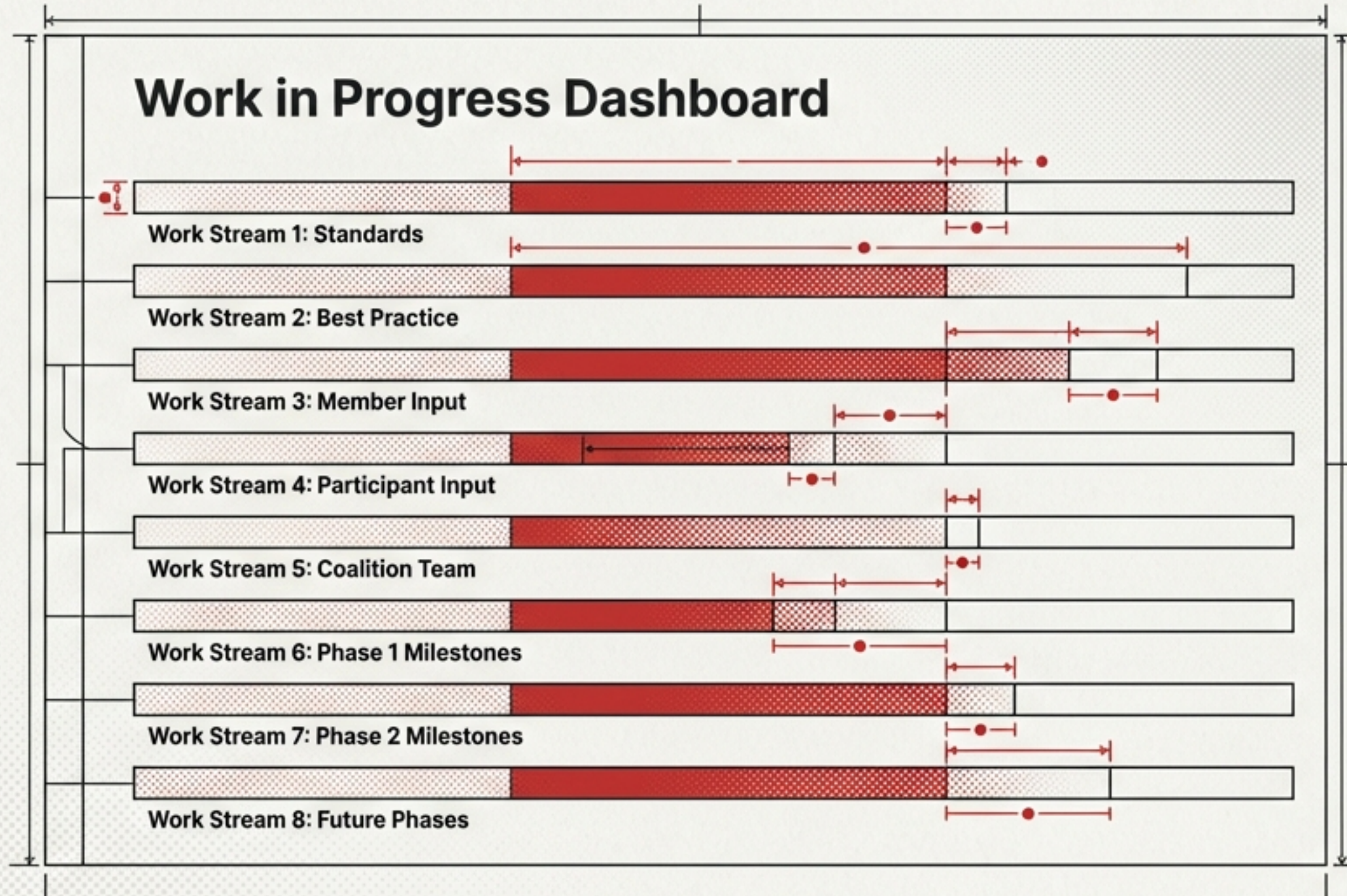
Sector Scope

Currently focused on original journalism, but open to expansion into other media sectors facing similar IP challenges.

Invitation

Membership is open to all organisations globally whose primary activity is the creation of original journalism.

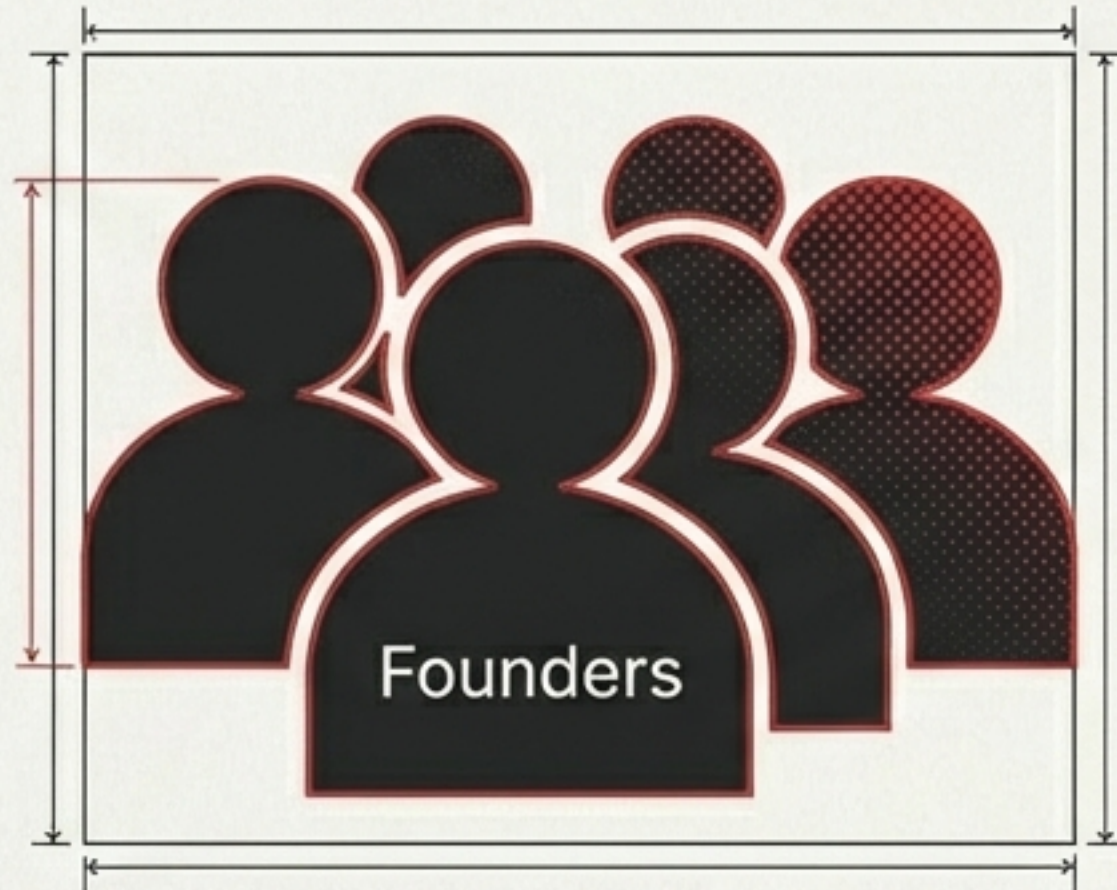
Operational roadmap



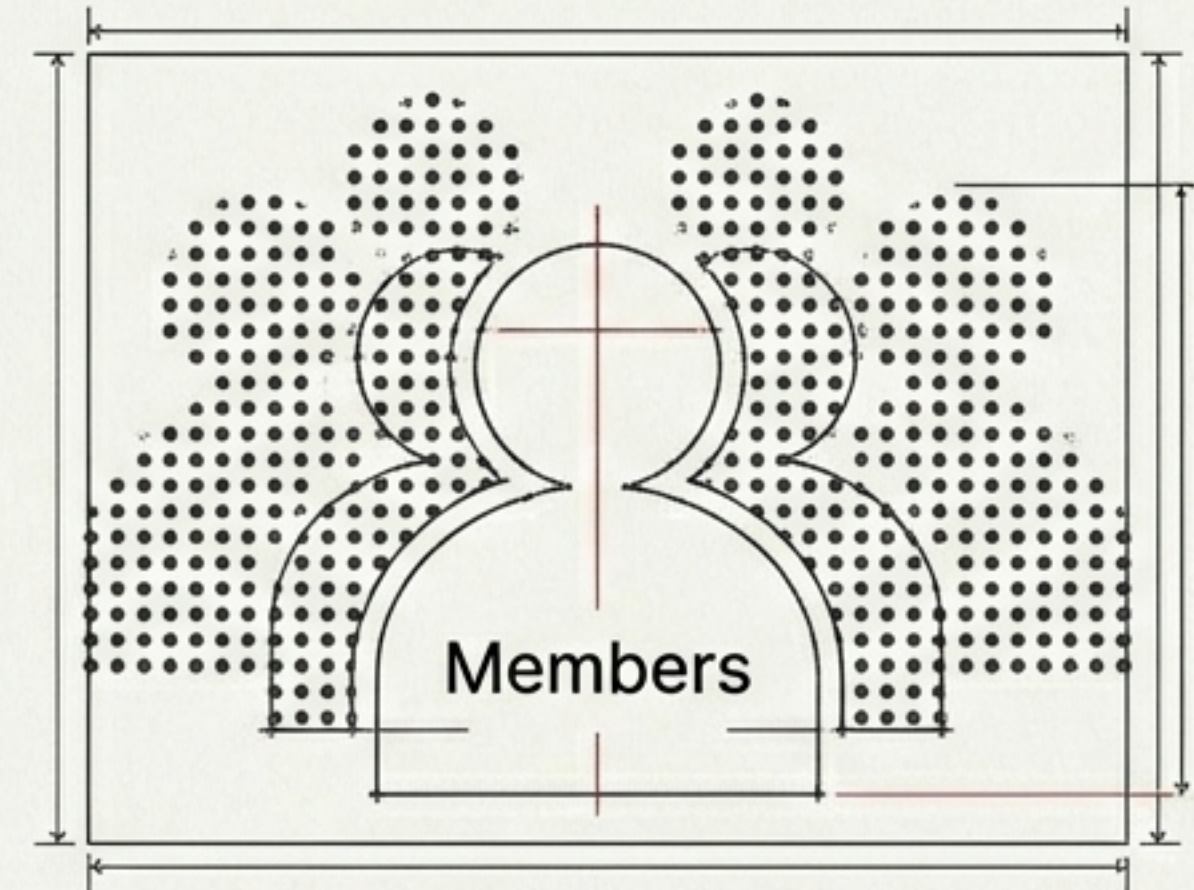
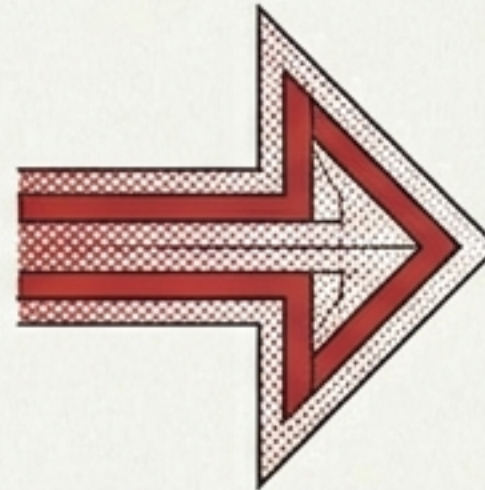
8 Active Work Streams with input from members, participants, and the Coalition team.

Pace: The project will move at pace, announcing key milestones in phases over the coming months.

Funding and governance



Phase 1: 100% funded to date by initial founders.



Phase 2: Future funding provided by membership fees.

SPUR is a non-profit project. Trade bodies can apply for affiliate membership.

The value of membership



Shape the Market:

Help design the infrastructure that defines the future of media.



Protect IP:

Technical tools to control and monitor content usage.



Secure Fair Value:

Ensure a transparent flow of data for fair commercial exchange.



Uphold Trust:

Maintain the standards of accuracy and accountability that sustain democracy.

The founding signatories

Tim Davie

BBC Director-General

Jon Slade

CEO, Financial Times

Anna Bateson

CEO, The Guardian

David Rhodes

Executive Chairman,
Sky News

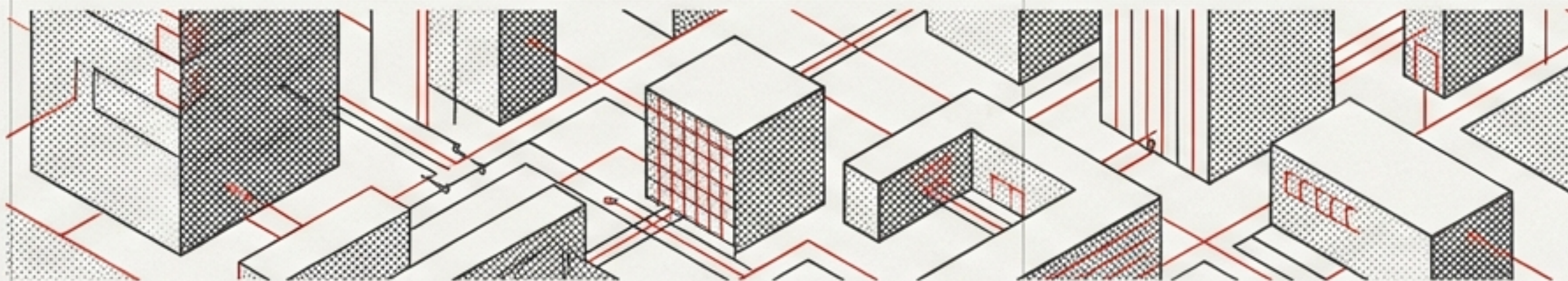
Anna Jones

CEO, Telegraph Media
Group

Join the coalition

We invite global leaders across publishing, broadcasting, media, and news to join us.

“Our goal is to help shape a market that rewards original reporting.”



General/Membership: info@spurcoalition.org

Media Enquiries: media.enquiries@spurcoalition.org